

Exercise 1

Tick the thoughts that you had at some point during your career. Discuss them with your partner.

Do you have a lot in common with them?



Exercise 2

If you've had at least two of these thoughts... you might have an imposter syndrome. What is it? Check the text below.

1. How would you summarise this text?
2. Individually highlight words and phrases that describe what an imposter can think or feel.
3. Which of them have you felt? Share with your partner.

IMPOSTER SYNDROME

THOUGHTS AND FEELINGS

Do you feel like a fraud? Many of us do. Perhaps you started a new job and believe you have less experience than you need, despite being the perfect candidate on paper. Or maybe your boss trusted you with an assignment that you feel totally unprepared to lead, regardless of your flawless track record.

There is a name for this feeling: imposter syndrome. Around one-third of young people suffer from it, and 70% of everyone else is likely to experience it at some point in their lives.

- Imposter syndrome typically shows up when we decide to take on new roles or new responsibilities, and it can result in feelings of self-doubt, anxiety, and guilt. Those who experience imposter syndrome may end up sabotaging their own success, obsessing over minor mistakes, or working twice as hard to prove themselves as a result.
- If you are beginning a new (or first) job, or just going through a change at work, overcoming imposter syndrome may feel impossible, like trying to remove a piece of clothing stuck to your skin. But if you fail to manage it now, it can have a detrimental impact on your performance and lead to burnout and depression in the longer term.



Exercise 3

It's time to fix this!

Check out coping mechanisms that help to overcome the imposter syndrome. Circle one method you'd like to practice today.



Exercise 4

Look how other professionals use facts to cope with their imposter syndrome. Complete their facts with the words in the box.

open-minded, reliable, versatile, consistent, engaged, resourceful, meticulous, integrity

1. I'm a _____ copywriter who hasn't missed a single deadline in two years. You can count on me.
2. As a startup founder, I like to think that I've very _____. Even when I have limited budget and time I can find a solution to a problem.
3. As a lawyer, I believe it's essential to have _____—I always act in my clients' best interests but at the same time refuse to change the truth, even under pressure.
4. I'm very _____ because I know how to meet my targets every month, not just when I feel motivated.
5. Working in an international team taught me to be _____—I've learned to listen without judgment and adapt to different perspectives.
6. I think of myself as a versatile designer because I can switch between branding, UI, and motion graphics depending on the project's needs.

7. I would describe myself as a _____ person who pays close attention to every detail when I review reports because even a small mistake can lead to major consequences.
8. I stay _____ during meetings—I ask questions and give input because I care about how our campaigns perform.

**Check with the partner. Which one word is not an adjective?
Which verb is used with this word?**

Exercise 5

In pairs match adjectives with actions that represent them.

meticulous, reliable, resourceful, open-minded,
versatile, integrity, consistent, engaged

1. _____

- Asks follow-up questions
- Shares helpful resources
- Suggests process improvements

2. _____

- Double-checks attachments before sending
- Takes organized meeting notes
- Follows guidelines carefully

3. _____

- Delivers quality under pressure
- Arrives on time every day
- Performs on the same level without unexpected changes

4. _____

- Replies on time
- Can keep promises
- Sends regular updates

5. _____

- Has strong principles and follows them
- Is honest
- Doesn't do unethical work.

6. _____

- Can find a solution to the problem by themselves
- Will find different, sometimes unusual ways to achieve the goal
- Can help others to make decisions

7. _____

- Switches roles when needed
- Knows various software and tools
- Can perform very different responsibilities

8. _____

- Accepts feedback even from juniors
- Doesn't mind new tools and approaches
- Joins brainstorming without judging

Exercise 6

Individually choose at least 3 adjectives that describe yourself. Think of specific achievements and facts that would prove your point. Make notes if needed.

While you're preparing, you might want to use the sentence structures from before:

- I would say I'm ... who ...
- I like to think that I'm ...
- V+ ing taught me to be ...
- I think of myself as ...
- I would describe myself as person who is able to...

Exercise 7

Tell about your positive qualities to your partner.

Carefully listen about their qualities.

Tell the whole class about your partner's strengths and support it with the facts they provided.

Exercise 8

Take 1 min and reflect on the things you said about yourself and heard about others. Do you believe in facts about yourself as much as about others?

